SUMMER SEASON NEWSLETTER

A Note from the President of the Board - Lincoln Cathers

Coolfont Re+Creation Conference Building

During the last three months the Board has carried on a dialogue with Sam Ashelman regarding the project to construct a building which will provide approximately 20 private rooms for conference attendees.

Sam's original plan was to construct one such building on the triangular piece of Ashelman owner property directly across from Treetop House and bounded by Cold Run Valley Road, Blue Bird Lane, and Mountainside Common Land. Review of the plans made it clear that the property was large enough to add at least two similar structures.

The reaction of Mountainside property owners varied from violent objections to indifference with most falling somewhere in the middle. Many of the homeowners expressed their feelings to Sam via letters and personal discussions.

The net result of the competing forces (Sam's need for such a building to help make his conference business more viable versus the generally negative reaction of the Mountainside owners) was that Sam proposed a compromise. His proposal included two features. First, he would lay out two additional lots next to the Kampelman lot along Blue Bird Lane and request from the Board, permission to have them included in the Mountainside property. Second, he would have a covenant placed in the deed of the remaining property stating that only one commercial structure could be built on the total trust. The Board intends to accept the two new lots as soon as the deed is presented.

Like most things in life, this compromise doesn't please everyone. However, the Board felt it was a fair compromise and responded to the major concern of all parts involved.

The three story building should be ready for use by September. A separate well is being drilled to service that building which will also be tied into the Treetop House system. Sam is currently considering building a solar heating system to heat hot water. It should be interesting to watch this project as it developes.

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BLUEBIRDS - We all can help!

"Those who were enjoying birds, 50 or more years ago, will recall that the bluebird was one of our commonest birds and that it nested freely close to human habitation, even in the residential sections of large cities. But now few people under 20 or 30 years of age, especially those who live east of the Rockies, can recall ever having seen a bluebird. To some, indeed, it must seem a bird that lives only in the fancy of poets and songwriters, a mythical creation that combines all of the most appealing avian traits."

"---a reasonable estimate is that during the course of the last 40 years the population of the eastern bluebird may have dropped 90% or more. If this relentless rate of decline continues it is quite conceivable that the eastern bluebird will disappear completely." L. Zeleny, The Bluebird

Connie and Adolph Hendrickson will be putting up 4 homemade bluebird nesting boxes in various spots around Coolfont which look like good nesting sites for bluebirds. They also will be responsible for their maintenance.

TAXES - A Glum Topic

This is the time of year when confusion over county taxes inevitably arises. The Sheriff of Morgan County publishes in the Morgan Messenger the names of delinquent taxpayers in early June. Most of us whose homes of record are elsewhere in the nation, fail to notice that the Sheriff issues only one notice, in August, for the "two halves." None is forthcoming for the second half.

Your current treasurer was alarmed to find the Association on the list, but has made his peace with the Sheriff. Some individuals in the Association need to clear this up. H-5, K-5, K-1, and C-1; please call the Sheriff's office. The amounts are small but there are now late charges.

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TENNIS CLINIC - Good Topic

Jim Washington, chairman of the Recreation Committee, has declared his intention to hold a tennis clinic at Coolfont this summer. This is good news for the kids and others with young ideas. Jim tells us that his personal plans and professional responsibilities must still be disentangled, but those interested should keep in touch with those ever accommodating and informed personnel at the Treetop desk. Jim promises to keep them informed on dates, hours, etc.

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BEACH CARDS

Please don't throw away the envelope without making sure you have the enclosed card which is your season pass to the lake and the swimming beach. Just show it to the person in charge. Your renters or guests are similarly privileged.

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COOKBOOK

Many, perhaps most, of us have contributed to the cookbook, "The Mountainside Cookbook," that has been created and compiled by Betty Fiske. The book, embellished by some remarkably apt and delightful illustrations by Mary Anne Haines, is now at the printers and should be ready by mid-July. Betty tells us that if she can recover her costs and a little reserve for another edition, the rest of the profits, if any, will be used for improvement of the common land.

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FIRE HAZARDS

To conclude on a serious note. We have had a dry spell that has imperilled Maryland, Virginia, and West Virginia crops. That time is now past and we are all basking in reasonable rains that have moistened the Mountainside in a lovely fashion.

But the dry spell has raised a specter. It seems quite clear that newspapers and other combustible materials in our fireplaces can easily rise through the chimney and fall back to earth still capable of starting a fire. The Board has been discussing the possibilities of such a catastrophe and some possible remedies. The best "fix" looks like a metal cap on all fireplaces together with a 1/2 inch screen between the chimney and the cap. More on this to come.

June/1977/mjp